

Sega Lindbergh – Initial D 4/5 Arcade Card Guide (Linux Loader) v2

This guide will walk you through how to create and use a card with Initial D 5, using Lindbergh Loader. (the steps for ID4 should be the same).

Prerequisites – In the test menu, have the option “Use Card Reader” set to YES. It’s under Game Assignments. You should also make sure you are using the latest version of Linux Loader as well as the latest linuxloader.ini file to go with it (older versions of ini may not work properly or at all with card file generation)

The overall flow for card creation works like this

- > Insert coins and start a game, first time game and create (buy) a card.
- > Play the first game through to completion (game over screen) so the card file is valid. (this step is very important)
- > When a valid card is created, Linux Loader by default will auto load that card when you start a game. (there is an option to disable this auto loading of card in linuxloader.ini so you have to press a button to load your card each time, see the section at the bottom of this document to read about disabling auto load of card)

CREATING A NEW CARD (first time play)

Step 1. Insert credits into the machine and start a game, you will now see the screen below, this screen is giving you 2 options.

TOP = Insert your Initial D Card.

BOTTOM = Press start to create a new card.

Since we don’t already have a card, and we are creating one, press START to create a new card at this screen. (please see the extra info at the bottom of this document to understand what will happen if you attempt to create a new card when one already exists...you shouldn’t do this unless you know exactly what you are doing, please read the info at the end of the document to understand why.)



Step 2. The screen you see below is a confirmation screen. “Are you sure you want to create a card”
Top option is YES, bottom option is NO. Select the top option.



Step 3. You will need at least 3 credits to buy a card. This next screen you see below tells you to insert 3 more coins to obtain a card. Insert 3 more credits to get past this screen, if you don't insert 3 credits here, it will stop the card creation process. If you already have 3 credits in the machine, you won't see this screen.



Step 4. Select man or woman for your avatar.



Step 5. Enter the name you want to use on your card. If you select the character in the far right right column (white square around it) it will change the characters to English.



As you can see below, characters are now in English and you can enter your name in English. Once you have finished, navigate to the red character in the bottom right and select it to save your name.



Step 6. Select a prefecture. This is for online play, it's used to find other players in your region to play against. THIS IS NOT USED AT THE TIME OF MAKING THIS GUIDE. You have to select one though, just select any option here.



Step 7. From here, you select a car and race, and drive the race, you should see your card name and license level D3 under your avatar in game (right side of screen). .

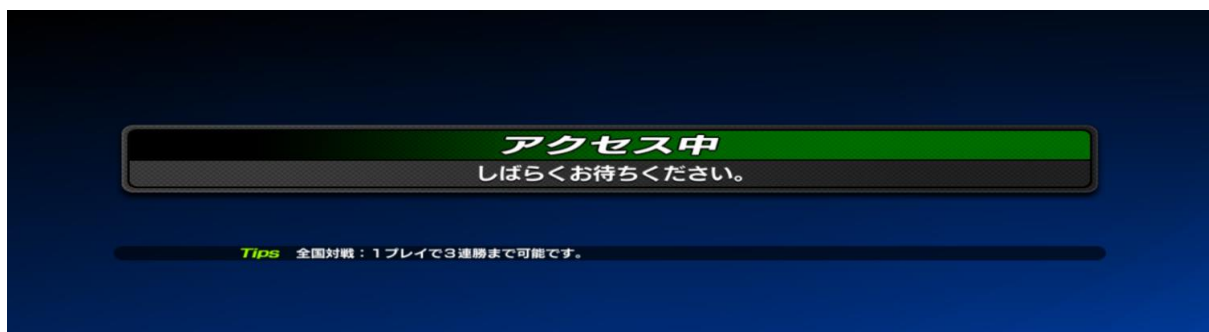


THERE IS A VERY IMPORTANT STEP HERE.... **Your card is not yet created properly.** You have to FINISH at least 1 race (or sit there at the start line and let the timer run out), and end the game completely for the card to create properly. **If you don't do this at this point, YOUR CARD FILE WILL BE INVALID.**

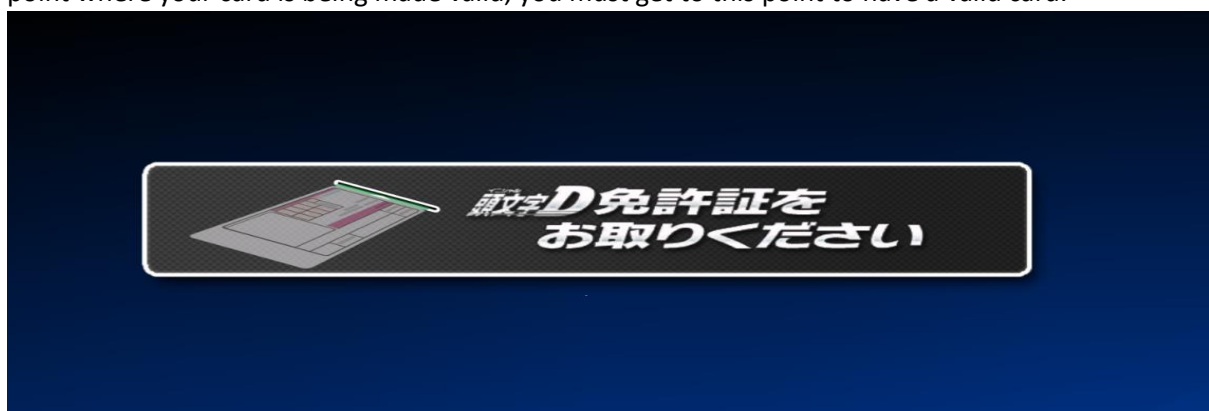
When you get to the end of the game, you will see the below screen. Select the option on the far right to end the game.



At this point you will see the following green banner show on screen, this is saving your card file



Then you will see this graphic of a card being ejected, you also hear a beep sound here. THIS is the point where your card is being made valid, you must get to this point to have a valid card.



After the card ejecting screen, you will see GAME OVER. Your card has been created, and is valid for use.



Now all you need to do is start another game, and your card should automatically load when asked to insert a card. If you get an error message at this point telling you that your card is invalid, see the EXTRA INFO section at the bottom of this guide for info on what to do when you get an invalid card error.

AUTO LOAD VS MANUAL LOAD OF CARD

By default, the setting in the Lindbergh Loader emulator is to auto load your card file. This means that when you see the screen to buy a new card or insert your card, IF a card file exists for this game, the loader will automatically insert the card for you.

There is an option in the linuxloader.ini files called ID_CARDFILE_AUTOLOAD, by default this setting is set to 1 which is on. If you want to disable auto loading the cardfile, then you should set this to 0. (make sure there is no # in front of the setting in linuxloader.ini, # will disable the setting)

This setting is explained below.

ID_CARDFILE_AUTOLOAD 1 = Auto load the card “default setting”

ID_CARDFILE_AUTOLOAD 0 = Disable auto loading card, user will have to press insert card button.

If you disable auto loading of a card, and attempt to load a card manually, but no card file exists. Nothing will happen. The button you use to load your card is configured in the linuxloader.ini file.

<<ADD SETTING NAME HERE THAT NEEDS TO BE CONFIGURED FOR BUTTON ADD CARD>>

SELECTING A FOLDER TO STORE YOUR ID CARD FILES

By default, the cardfile will be stored alongside the game elf file (see extra info below for an understanding of the card file). There is a setting in linuxloader.ini file where you can set the directory you want the card files to be saved in.

ID_CARDFOLDER

Adding a path to this setting will force the game to save to and load your cardfiles from the specified folder.

EXTRA INFO

When you choose to create a card at the start of a game, the file InidCrd000.crd is created in the game directory. The card file at this point is not a valid card, you won't be able to load it. You must play through 1 game and end that game as detailed above. When you get to the game over screen, then your card will be saved and be a valid card file that can be loaded to play future games. (this is how the real machine works, it doesn't actually write your new card for you until the end of the game when it spits it out of the card reader for you).

If for some reason you don't complete this first game, that card file will exist in the game directory (or the directory you specified in linuxloader.ini) and it will be invalid. When you goto start that game, it will try to auto load the card, you will get an error "card is invalid" message. At this point, you will need to go and delete this file from your game directory and go through the process again. Just make sure you complete that first game when you create the card.

If you have auto load card turned off, and choose to make a new card at the start of the game (when there's already an existing one), the game will create a new card and increment the number on the file by 1.

Example: You have InidCrd000.crd in your game folder, then you start a game and create a new card, the game will now create InidCrd001.crd in ther game folder. So you will have 2 card files, InidCrd000.crd & InidCrd001.crd. The problem here is that you don't get to choose what card the game loads, in auto load mode, or in manual button mode. So... the game will automaticlly choose the card with the lowest number to load. This is where creating a new card, when one already exists causes problems. You will not be able to load the second/third etc cards you create, unless you manually rename them or remove the lowr number cards. Some people will be able to manage this manually without issue, it just depends on your level of computer experience.

You can backup your card files by making a copy of the card file from your game folder. Just remember you will need to do this each time you play if you want to have an updated backup of your card